

Key terms used throughout this chapter

database – a persistent structured collection of data that allows people to extract information in a way that meets their needs

single-table database – a database contains only one table

table – a collection of related records in a database

record – a collection of fields that describe one item

field – a database table

data type – a classification of how data is stored and displayed, and of which operations that can be performed on the stored value

primary key – a field in a database that uniquely identifies a record

Structured Query Language (SQL) – the standard query language for writing scripts to obtain useful information from a relational database.

SQL scripts – a list of SQL commands that perform a given task, often stored in a file so the script can be reused

SELECT – an SQL command that fetches specified fields (columns) from a table

FROM – an SQL command that identifies the table to use

WHERE – an SQL command to include only those records (rows) in a query that match a given condition

ORDER BY – an SQL command that sorts the results from a query by a given column either alphabetically or numerically

SUM – an SQL command that returns the sum of all the values in a field (column); used with SELECT

COUNT – an SQL command that counts the number of records (rows) in which the field (column) matches a specified condition; used with SELECT